



Summarization of Discussion-Subject Segments in Meeting Minutes: Annotation Guidelines

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Introduction

These annotation guidelines were developed within the scope of the *CitiLink – Enhancing municipal transparency and citizen engagement through AI: from unstructured to structured data* project (<https://citilink.inesctec.pt/>), which aims to develop an automatic system to facilitate the understanding of city council meeting minutes. The project seeks to transform the free text of these minutes into structured and concise summaries, identifying the topics discussed, organized by area of competence, as well as the positions taken by municipal representatives.

Ultimately, a functional prototype will be made available to help citizens, journalists, and policymakers access the information contained in the minutes. The project involves partnerships with six municipalities: Alandroal, Campo Maior, Covilhã, Fundão, Guimarães, and Porto.

This manual provides the guidelines for identifying the *discussion-subject segments* in city council meeting minutes and for producing accurate, consistent, and concise summaries for each of these segments. These text segments correspond to portions of the minutes that describe what was discussed and deliberated during each item of the meeting's agenda. For every text segment, annotators must first determine the *theme*, i.e., the main focus of the discussion, which is established prior to the summarization stage and serves as its input. The present document details the linguistic criteria and methodological principles required to express the central idea of each text segment in a concise form, ensuring that the essential content is preserved and clearly conveyed without unnecessary detail.

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A. Subject

Definition: Set of information that structures and organizes the items discussed and/or deliberated during the council meeting. Only the subjects discussed as part of the agenda items will be considered.

I. Entity structures

- **A.1. Theme¹** (free text box)

Definition: Concise and standardized formulation of the main content of the subject in question. The theme must be written as an *informative title*, based on the content of the discussion-subject segment and on the wording used in the minutes.

Markable: The text span most similar to the agenda item. To establish the markable, consider the following criteria:

- The segment should be as close as possible to the paragraph containing the deliberation(s) (if present). If not possible, annotate the segment introducing a new subject in the body of the text or, alternatively, the agenda item itself. In these cases, the same segment may correspond simultaneously to both the agenda item and the topic markables and must be annotated twice, once for each parameter (see (1)).
- When more than one deliberation occurs under the same subject, annotate the segment encompassing everything deliberated, regardless of location in the text, provided it is outside the paragraph(s) containing the deliberations.
- Annotators must NOT include in the markable the verb expressing the subject's main eventuality; this verb must instead be represented in the Theme through a nominalization (cf. (3)).
- Nominalizations referring to the subject's main eventuality may be included in the markable (cf. (3) and (4)).
- Do not annotate themes in the agenda index (or other theme lists, if present) — only annotate in the body of the text where the subject is actually discussed and deliberated.

¹ This manual should be read in conjunction with the general annotation guidelines: *CitiLink – Guidelines for the Annotation and Summarization of City Council Meeting Minutes (Version 1.3.0, February 2026)*. In the present manual, the *Theme* corresponds to the element used as input for summarization. Its definition remains identical to that provided in the general annotation guidelines. However, the criteria for establishing the *Theme* markable follow the combined criteria defined for both *Topic* and *Theme* in the general annotation guidelines. This reflects the specific role of the *Theme* in the summarization task, where it captures the central content that serves as the basis for writing the summary.

- Annotate only the themes of the subjects described in the agenda (typically shown in bold, uppercase, and/or numbered in the PDF/Word minutes).
- If present, the final punctuation mark (colon, semicolon, etc.) is NOT included in the text span.
- Personal information in the markable segment (e.g., names of individuals) must be replaced by *citizen/citizens* in the theme description and annotated accordingly (cf. (7)).
- When present, the closing paragraph of the meeting (e.g., “At eleven fifty, the mayor declared the meeting closed, for the record of which this minute was drawn up.”) should NOT be considered a topic markable, even if it contains references to administrative or procedural actions.

The text should be written in the free text box according to the following criteria:

- **Wording — general considerations:**
 - Concise and informative titles, up to 15 words;
 - The theme (title) should be constructed to minimize ambiguity, ensuring that it is understandable and easily distinguishable from other annotated subjects;
 - Create the theme based on the identified subject, using the vocabulary from the minutes whenever possible; when the markable does not allow for full contextualization of the theme, draw on the wording used in the agenda item or in the deliberation paragraph(s);
 - Favor the use of the most general (holonym) term to identify the object of the subject, without compromising overall understanding;
 - Modifiers that characterize the object of the subject in a specific or technical way should be omitted or simplified whenever their inclusion compromises conciseness or exceeds the word limit;
 - Special cases: whenever the phrase “*Municipality of [city/municipality name]*” refers to the municipality where the meeting takes place (i.e., the municipality of the annotated minutes), it should be shortened to “*Municipality*” in the theme (cf. (2));
- **Nominal expressions:**
 - Begin with a nominalization/eventive noun;
 - The nominalization denoting the main eventuality of the topic markable can be included in the theme (e.g., approval, authorization, granting; cf. (4)-(6));

- Special cases: (i) standardize with the nominalization “*absence of*” whenever the theme refers to the non-occurrence or inexistence of something; (ii) for the verb *approve*, standardize with the nominalization “*approval of*”;
- **Use of capital letters:** capitalize the initial letters of names of monuments, temples, and buildings (e.g., *Castelo de Ouguela*, *Sé Catedral do Porto*, *Museu Arqueológico Municipal José Monteiro*), toponyms (e.g., *Rua do Castelo*, *Praça da República*, *Freguesia da Barroca*), and the title *Mayor*;
- **Punctuation:** do not include final periods; do not include quotation marks around project names (simplify project/contract designations whenever possible); replace dashes with prepositions whenever possible;
- **Acronyms and abbreviations:** use well-established acronyms and abbreviations (those widely recognized by the general public or officially adopted by the entities themselves) (cf. (4) and (8)), whenever possible; when no established acronym or abbreviation exists, use the full name of the entity written out in full. In this case, the number of words in the full name is *not* counted toward the 15-word limit for the theme;
- **Other considerations:**
 - when the markable includes the name of an individual, it must be replaced in the theme by “*a citizen*” or “*X citizens*” (cf. (7)). The term “*citizen/citizens*” should be used regardless of gender, and the number should match the number of people mentioned in the topic;
 - use the ISO 8601 date format (YYYY-MM-DD) to write dates, when needed.

Examples:

- (1) 1. Minute of the public meeting of the Municipal Executive held on 2 May 2022. [**agenda item/subject**]
(PT: *1. Ata da reunião pública do Executivo Municipal de 2 de maio de 2022.*)
- (2) Celebration of the cooperation protocol between the Municipality [~~of Covilhã~~] and the Municipality of Fundão
(PT: *Celebração do protocolo de cooperação entre o Município [~~da Covilhã~~] e o Município do Fundão*)
- (3) **Deliberation paragraph:** The City Council deliberated to approve the zoning of traffic in the North Access - Teixoso.
Annotated topic: zoning of traffic in the North Access - Teixoso
Theme: Zoning of traffic in the North Access in Teixoso

(PT: **Parágrafo da deliberação:** A Câmara deliberou aprovar o ordenamento de trânsito no Acesso Norte - Teixoso.

Tópico anotado: ordenamento de trânsito no Acesso Norte - Teixoso

Tema: Ordenamento de trânsito no Acesso Norte em Teixoso)

- (4) **Deliberation paragraph:** The City Council took note and unanimously deliberated to approve the proposal presented. (Granting of financial support – Santa Casa da Misericórdia do Fundão)

Annotated topic (D.2.): Granting of financial support – Santa Casa da Misericórdia do Fundão

(PT: **Parágrafo da deliberação:** A Câmara Municipal tomou conhecimento e deliberou, por unanimidade, aprovar a proposta apresentada. (Atribuição de apoio financeiro – Santa Casa da Misericórdia do Fundão).

Tópico anotado (D.2.): Atribuição de apoio financeiro – Santa Casa da Misericórdia do Fundão)

- (5) **Markable:** Petty cash funds for 2022 – amendment

Theme: Amendment of petty cash funds for 2022

(PT: **Markable:** Fundos fixos para 2022 – alteração

Tema: Alteração dos fundos fixos para 2022)

- (6) **Markable:** Granting of financial support – Santa Casa da Misericórdia do Fundão

Theme: Granting of financial support to SCM Fundão

(PT: **Markable:** Atribuição de apoio financeiro – Santa Casa da Misericórdia do Fundão

Tema: Atribuição de apoio financeiro à SCM do Fundão)

- (7) **Markable:** Request by Maria João Neves [personal information] for the purchase of a perpetual grave in four monthly instalments

Theme: Approval of a citizen's request to purchase a perpetual grave in instalments

(PT: **Markable:** pedido de Maria João Neves [informação pessoal] para aquisição de uma sepultura perpétua em quatro prestações mensais

Tema: Aprovação do pedido de um cidadão para aquisição de uma sepultura perpétua em prestações)

- (8) Celebration of the support protocol between the Municipality and UBI [~~University of Beira Interior~~]

(PT: Celebração do protocolo de apoio entre o Município e a UBI [~~Universidade da Beira Interior~~])

- **A.2. Summary**

In this project, summarization will be carried out on segments of city council meeting minutes, corresponding to subjects discussed during the meeting. Due to their nature, the length of the source texts varies greatly, as does the range of topics addressed. To reduce subjectivity and standardize the format of the summaries, textual models are proposed for annotators to follow.

A.2.1. Defining the summarization task

To summarize a text is to reduce it to its most essential parts, (i) using clear and precise wording; (ii) respecting the meaning, structure, and type of enunciation; (iii) avoiding any element of appreciation or any other comment of a personal nature. In general terms, the key concepts for creating a good summary are:

- **Select** – remove words or phrases that refer to secondary details, such as comments, examples, quotations, redundant expressions and sentences;
- **Generalize** – by using hypernyms, synonyms, or encompassing expressions with anaphoric value;
- **Reduce** – redundancies, periphrasis, entire sentences to adjectives, complements, determiners, pronouns, or adverbs;
- **(Re)construct** – transform simple sentences into complex ones or replace a set of sentences with a single one that incorporates them.

In a good summary, the source text is not reproduced through the use of identical words, phrases, or entire sentences, with or without quotations, although some key vocabulary may be used. Furthermore, comments, misrepresentations, and personal intrusions by the summary writer should be avoided.

A.2.2. Stages of preparing the summary

In this project, the following steps are suggested for each annotator to produce a summary. (*Adapted from Friend, 2002.*)

A.2.2.1. Considering the discussion-subject segment

- i. Reflect on what the main subject of the text segment you are about to read might be. In principle, it should coincide, wholly or partially, with the subject previously identified in the annotation tool for that segment.
- ii. Read the entire text segment.

- iii. Think of the segment as a whole. What does it mean? Make sure you fully understand the entire segment.

A.2.2.2. Identifying the main idea

- i. Ask yourself two questions: (a) What is the discussion-subject segment about (what is its theme)? (b) What is the message being conveyed?
- ii. Your answer will be the central idea of the segment: the idea to which all other ideas expressed in the segment refer.
- iii. This idea should be general enough to include all the specific aspects mentioned in the segment, but not so general that it becomes vague.
- iv. Write the main idea preferably in your own words. Avoid expressions like 'is about' ("é sobre"), 'deals with' ("trata de"), or 'the way in which' ("a maneira como"). Try to create a synthesis sentence, which will serve as the opening of the summary.
- v. This sentence should follow one of the following formats, depending on whether the text segment to be reduced contains any form of positioning (i.e., whether the discussion-subject segment contains information about a formal vote that took place during the meeting):

- **Option A-1** (the discussion-subject segment includes some form of positioning):

Agent² + verb + Positioning ('by majority' ("por maioria") OR 'unanimously' ("por unanimidade")) + Theme³

Example:

(9) [The City Council] [approved] [by majority] [the draft of the program contract to be signed between the municipality of Fundão and the Parish of Castelo Novo].

(PT: [A Câmara] [aprovou] [por maioria] [a minuta do contrato-programa a celebrar entre o município do Fundão e a Freguesia de Castelo Novo].)

- **Option B-1** (the discussion-subject segment DOES NOT include some form of positioning):

² The notion of *Agent* used here corresponds to the semantic function as defined in ISO 24617-4: an entity that purposefully or knowingly starts an event and that exists independently of the event. An agent is typically an animate entity; however, non-animate entities, such as organizations, can also be perceived as agents.

³ The notion of *Theme* used here corresponds to the semantic function as defined in ISO 24617-4: a participant in events that is essential for the event to occur, although the event does not structurally change it. It does not control the event, and it exists independently of the event.

B1. active sentence (the Agent is identified in the text segment)

Agent + verb + Goal⁴ + Theme

Example:

- (10) [Councilor X] [informed] [the City Council] [that there were citizens living in appalling sanitary conditions].
(PT: [O Vereador X] [informou] [a Câmara] [de que existiam munícipes a viver em condições sanitárias indignas].)

B2. passive sentence (the Agent IS NOT identified in the text segment)

Goal + verb (passive) + Theme

OR

Theme + verb (passive)

Examples:

- (11) [The City Council] [was informed] [that there were residents living in appalling sanitary conditions].
(PT: [A Câmara] [foi informada] [de que existiam munícipes a viver em condições sanitárias indignas].)
OR
[The balance sheet for the calendar year 2024] [was presented].
(PT: [Foi apresentado] [o balancete referente ao ano civil de 2024].)

In the previous schemas, the *Theme* corresponds to the annotation previously created in INCEpTION. This annotation should be transposed word-for-word into the summary whenever possible—that is, whenever no modification is required due, for example, to the need to integrate the *Theme* into the syntactic structure of the summary sentence or to the possibility of reducing the number of words used.

List of verbs to be used in the first sentence: to say (*dizer*), to assert (*afirmar*), to tell (*contar*), to declare (*declarar*), to answer (*responder*), to allege (*alegar*), to assure (*assegurar*), to conclude (*concluir*), to inform (*informar*), to order (*ordenar*), to prohibit (*proibir*), to request (*pedir*), to invite (*convidar*), to ask (*perguntar*), to thank (*agradecer*), to congratulate (*felicitar, dar os parabéns*), to welcome (*dar as boas-vindas*), to regret (*lamentar*), to complain (*reclamar*), to refuse (*recusar*), to commit (*comprometer-se*), to appoint (to a position) (*nomear (para um cargo)*), to

⁴ The notion of "Goal" used here corresponds to the semantic function as defined in ISO 24617-4: an entity that corresponds to the end point of an event that is not defined by location or time and that exists independently of the event.

discharge (*exonerar*), to approve (*aprovar*), to declare (*declarar*), to decide (*decidir*), etc.

A.2.2.3. Identifying the key supporting ideas

- i. Identify subsections within the discussion-subject segment, that is, group sentences/paragraphs that share the same subject. Identify the most important idea of each of these subsections of the segment (these ideas correspond to some form of development of the main idea previously identified).
- ii. The most important ideas that develop the main idea are usually reiterated in distinct ways throughout the segment.
- iii. Do not annotate details, examples, anecdotes, or digressions; instead, highlight the essential ideas to which these details refer.
- iv. The remaining sentences of the summaries must capture the remaining essential information from the discussion-subject segment. The way these sentences should be structured varies depending on whether or not there is a positioning:

- **Option A-2** (the discussion-subject segment includes some form of positioning):

The synthesis sentence (first sentence) should be complemented with additional information relevant to understanding the *Subject*, namely by indicating: (i) the purpose of the deliberation (for what purpose?); (ii) the rationale (reason) behind the deliberation (why?); and (iii) other types of information (when? where? how?...).

Note: this list is merely indicative; what matters most is selecting the essential ideas from the text segment being summarized.

Example:

(12) The Council approved by majority vote the draft of the program contract to be entered into between the municipality of Fundão and the Parish of Castelo Novo. This contract aims at the renovation of the Guard House [for what?]. The decision was based on the arguments put forward in a proposal presented by the Vice President [why?].

(PT: *A Câmara aprovou por maioria a minuta do contrato-programa a celebrar entre o município do Fundão e a Freguesia de Castelo Novo. Este contrato destina-se à requalificação da Casa do Guarda. [para quê?]. A deliberação baseou-se nos argumentos invocados numa proposta apresentada pelo Senhor Vice-Presidente. [porquê?]*)

- **Option B-2** (the discussion-subject segment DOES NOT include some form of positioning):

The synthesis sentence (first sentence) could be complemented with additional information relevant to understanding the *Subject*, namely by indicating (when applicable): (i) when? (ii) where? (iii) for what? (iv) how? (v) why? (vi) other information?

Note: this list is merely indicative; what matters most is selecting the essential ideas from the text segment being summarized.

Example:

- (13) The President reported Dispatch No. 3 on the Budgeting and Management of Personnel Expenditures for the year 2023. This dispatch provides information on the projected personnel expenses and on the costs associated with changes in remuneration levels, as well as on the Statement of Payments and Receivables in arrears. The Municipality has no overdue payments. There are some overdue receivables arising from processes related to EU funds, rents, and water service cases. (72 words)

(PT: *[O Presidente] Deu conhecimento do seu Despacho n.º 3 sobre a Orçamentação e Gestão das Despesas com Pessoal para o ano de 2023. Trata-se de um despacho que dá informação sobre despesas previstas com pessoal e dos encargos com a alteração de posicionamento remuneratório e também da Declaração de Pagamentos e Recebimentos em atraso. O Município não tem pagamentos em atraso. Há alguns recebimentos em atraso que resultam de processos ligados a fundos comunitários, rendas, processos de águas.*)

Summary:

The President reported on Dispatch No. 3 regarding the Budgeting and Management of Personnel Expenditures for 2023. There are no overdue payments, although there are some overdue receivables. **[28 words]**

(PT: *O Presidente da Câmara informou sobre o Despacho n.º 3 relativo à Orçamentação e Gestão das Despesas com Pessoal para 2023. Não existem pagamentos em atraso, embora haja recebimentos atrasados.*)

A.2.2.4. Drafting the summary

- i. Draft the summary, starting with the main idea and then including the remaining ideas that in some way develop the main idea.
- ii. Do not repeat any information in the summary.
- iii. When drafting the summary, the following aspects should be observed:
 - Avoid using direct speech.
 - Maintain the verb tenses of the original text.
 - Use the third person.
 - Respect the proposed word count (typically a percentage of the original text; cf. A.2.3).
 - Connect sentences and paragraphs using connectors (or syntactic constructions that mark connections), prioritizing the logical organization of information.
- iv. Please note the following rules (specifically designed to standardize minutes summaries):
 - Use Mr./Ms. (“Sr./Sr.ª”) before the names/titles of meeting participants.
 - Always use the phrase “*Presidente da Câmara*” (Mayor).
 - When the text segment describes a proposal, omit its proposer from the summary.
 - For dates, use the ISO format (year-month-day).
 - When voting takes place, include in the summary the general voting results in the summary (how many votes in favor/against/abstentions).
 - When voting takes place, place the phrase summarizing the result in the first sentence of the summary, set off by commas (e.g., “..., by majority, ...”).
 - When the text segment includes any dialogue or a statement by one of the meeting participants, refer to these statements in the summary.
 - Try to maintain the basic Portuguese sentence constituents order (SVO), except in cases where this order is altered by a linguistic factor, such as the presence of syntactically heavy constituents.
 - When referring to monetary values:
 - (i) use numerals;
 - (ii) do not use a period to separate the hundreds from the thousands;
 - (iii) always include digits for cents;
 - (iv) use the euro symbol (€) without leaving a space between the last digit and the symbol.
 - For proper names of programs, institutions, etc., use the corresponding acronyms or abbreviations if they are listed in the Dicionário da Língua Portuguesa of Academia das Ciências de Lisboa (<https://dicionario.acad-ciencias.pt/>). In all other cases, acronyms should

not be used (only the full name).

- For names of public institutions, omit the acronym “I.P.” or “E.M.”
- In cases where the minutes indicate the absence of an action/act, transform the *Theme* into a sentence.

Example:

(14) **Text in the minutes:** No permutative budgetary change was put forward for discussion/approval in this item.

(PT: *No presente ponto não foi colocado à discussão/aprovação qualquer alteração orçamental permutativa.*)

Theme: Absence of a permutative budgetary change

(PT: *Ausência de alteração orçamental permutativa*)

Proposed summary: There were no changes to the permutative budgetary change.

(PT: *Não houve qualquer alteração orçamental permutativa.*)

A.2.2.5. Reviewing the summary

- i. Review all the previous steps.
- ii. Verify that:
 - (a) the first sentence expresses the main idea of the entire text segment;
 - (b) the remaining sentences express the ideas that develop the main idea (and condense each of the subsections)
- iii. Ensure that you have preferably used your own words to express all the ideas from the text segment
- iv. Verify that the summary is well-written and coherent.

A.2.2.6. Evaluating the summary

- i. Verify whether the produced summary achieves the highest rating on the following five parameters of the evaluation scale.
- ii. If you consider that your summary does not achieve the maximum score for any of the parameters, review the identified issues and determine solutions by rewriting the summary.
- iii. In cases where it is not possible to include all the information considered essential in a summary that respects the word limit (see below **A.2.3 – V**), priority should be given to including essential information in the summary rather than strictly adhering to the word limit.

A.2.3. Components of the Citilink Summarization Evaluation Scale

(Partially adapted from the scale proposed in Li & Wang, 2021)

A.2.3.1. Coverage of ideas

Definition: The number of ideas from the source text included in the summary; a central aspect of a good summary.

Performance levels:

- 5 EXCELLENT:** The summary includes **all** ideas from the source text.
- 4 VERY GOOD:** The summary includes **most** ideas from the source text.
- 3 GOOD:** The summary includes about **half** of the ideas from the source text.
- 2 FAIR:** The summary includes **only some** of the ideas from the source text.
- 1 POOR:** The summary includes **only one or none** of the ideas from the source text (if there are more).

A.2.3.2. Integration

Definition: Relates to how information is conveyed in the summary, i.e., the extent to which information from the source text is presented succinctly, using strategies such as: eliminating unnecessary information; combining and condensing information into sentences and paragraphs; reordering information in the text to make it more compact while simultaneously easier to understand; and appropriately using connectors and/or syntactic structures that mark discursive relations.

Performance levels A: Polythematic source texts (with two or more ideas)

- 5 EXCELLENT:** The summary rearranges the order of statements logically and displays **excellent** examples of integration and connectors.
- 4 VERY GOOD:** The summary rearranges the order of statements logically and displays **good** examples of integration and connectors.
- 3 GOOD:** The summary rearranges the order of statements logically and displays **moderate** examples of integration and connectors.
- 2 FAIR:** The summary basically follows the order of the source text (if the source text is not monothematic and has several paragraphs), with **few instances** of reordering and integration.
- 1 POOR:** The summary follows the original order of the statements in the source text (if the source text is not monothematic and has several paragraphs) and shows **rare** examples of appropriate integration and connectors.

Performance level B: Monothematic source texts (with only one idea) and of short length

- 5 EXCELLENT:** The summary shows **excellent** examples of integration.
- 4 VERY GOOD:** The summary shows **good** examples of integration.
- 3 GOOD:** The summary shows **moderate** examples of integration.
- 2 FAIR:** The summary shows **few** instances of integration.
- 1 POOR:** The summary is a **paraphrase** of the source text.

A.2.3.3. *Linguistic correctness*

Definition: Relates to normative aspects of language use and lexical and syntactic variety.

Performance levels:

5 EXCELLENT: The summary displays **complete** linguistic correctness, syntactic and lexical variety and appropriateness.

4 VERY GOOD: The summary displays complete linguistic correctness, although with **some shortcomings** in syntactic and lexical variety or appropriateness.

3 GOOD: The summary displays complete linguistic correctness, although with **occasional shortcomings** in syntactic or lexical variety or appropriateness.

2 FAIR: The summary displays **some lapses** in linguistic correctness and some shortcomings in syntactic or lexical variety or appropriateness.

1 POOR: The summary displays **multiple lapses** in linguistic correctness and in syntactic or lexical variety or appropriateness.

A.2.3.4. *Use of source text vocabulary*

Definition: Relates to the precise and literal use of linguistic expressions from the source text.

Performance levels:

5 EXCELLENT: The summary contains **almost entirely** the annotator's own words and sentence structures (except for non-substitutable expressions, such as proper names or equivalents, e.g., identification of dispatches), in addition to **precise use of information from the source text**.

4 VERY GOOD: The summary contains **mostly** the annotator's own words and sentence structures (except for non-substitutable expressions, such as proper names or equivalents, e.g., identification of dispatches), in addition to **precise use of information from the source text**.

3 GOOD: The summary **partially** contains the annotator's own words and sentence structures (except for non-substitutable expressions, such as proper names or equivalents, e.g., identification of dispatches), in addition to **precise use of information from the source text**.

2 FAIR: The summary **partially** contains the annotator's own words and sentence structures (except for non-substitutable expressions, such as proper names or equivalents, e.g., identification of dispatches), with **instances of imprecise use of information from the source text**.

1 POOR: The summary does **not** contain the annotator's own words and sentence structures.

A.2.3.5. Summary length

Definition: Relates to compliance with length limits. It *does not apply to* discussion-subject *segments shorter than 60 words*.

Performance levels:

5 EXCELLENT: The summary **meets** the following limits – for source texts up to 120 words: 1/2; for source texts between 121 and 160 words: between 1/2 and 1/3; for source texts longer than 160 words: between 1/3 and 1/4.

4 VERY GOOD: The summary **exceeds** the following limits **by 1 to 4 words** – for source texts up to 80 words: 1/2; for source texts between 81 and 120 words: between 1/2 and 1/3; for source texts longer than 120 words: between 1/3 and 1/4.

3 GOOD: The summary **exceeds** the following word limits **by 5 to 7 words** – for source texts up to 80 words: 1/2; for source texts between 81 and 120 words: between 1/2 and 1/3; for source texts longer than 120 words: between 1/3 and 1/4.

2 FAIR: The summary **exceeds** the following word limits **by 8 to 10 words** – for source texts up to 80 words: 1/2; for source texts between 81 and 120 words: between 1/2 and 1/3; for source texts longer than 120 words: between 1/3 and 1/4.

1 POOR: The summary **exceeds** the following limits **by 11 words or more** – for source texts up to 80 words: 1/2; for source texts between 81 and 120 words: between 1/2 and 1/3; for source texts longer than 120 words: between 1/3 and 1/4.

A.2.4. Examples of summaries

A.2.4.1. Alandroal 001_2024 *(the underlined parts of the text indicate the key information considered when drafting the summary)*

Text to be summarized:

[Visit to a new hospital] The Mayor reported that on the 21st he participated in a visit organized by ARS Alentejo to the construction site of the new Central Hospital of Évora. District mayors were invited, the works and progress were inspected, and it was noted that this is a project of considerable scale, with very serious objectives to serve the entire region. **[Specification – medical advantages of the new hospital]** It was also mentioned that the new hospital will not only be a reference hospital for healthcare provision throughout the Alentejo region, which means that some highly specialized

services will need to be redirected to Lisbon; the majority of healthcare provision will, however, take place within the region. **[New specification – economic and social advantages of the new hospital]** This aspect is very important, but it should also be noted that the hospital will serve the region in other ways, as it will act as a development anchor: a medical school is planned—the University of Évora is already preparing the application and owns land adjacent to the hospital. A number of biotechnology and healthcare companies are intending to establish themselves near the hospital, turning it into a development hub, both for training and attracting qualified professionals to the region and for attracting high-tech companies, which in turn foster the creation of skilled employment. On this scale, the project is comparable to Alqueva or other major infrastructural projects, creating a significant social and economic dynamic with impact across the entire region. **[250 words]**

(PT: **[visita a um novo hospital]** O Sr. Presidente informou que no dia 21 participou numa visita promovida pela ARS Alentejo às obras do novo Hospital Central de Évora. Foram convidados os autarcas do distrito, visitaram-se as obras, a evolução dos trabalhos e trata-se de uma obra de uma dimensão considerável, com objetivos muito sérios de vir a servir toda a região. **[especificação – vantagens médicas do novo hospital]** Falou-se também que o novo hospital não vai ser só um hospital de referência no que diz respeito a prestação de cuidados de saúde para toda a região Alentejo, o que significa que algumas especialidades terão que ser reencaminhadas para Lisboa, por serem muito especializadas, a maior parte de toda a prestação de cuidados passará a ser feita na região. **[nova especificação – vantagens económicas e sociais do novo hospital]** Este aspeto é muito importante, mas há que referir também que o hospital vai servir a região de outra forma pois será uma âncora de desenvolvimento porque está prevista a criação de uma escola de medicina -- a Universidade de Évora já está a preparar a candidatura, já tem os terrenos junto ao hospital -- há já um conjunto de empresas ligadas à biotecnologia e de cuidados de saúde a pretenderem instalar-se na envolvente do hospital, tornando-se num centro de desenvolvimento quer para formar e atrair profissionais qualificados para a região, quer para atrair empresas de tecnologia de ponta, por sua vez potenciadoras de criação de emprego qualificado. Portanto, à sua escala é um projeto comparável ao Alqueva ou outros projetos estruturantes, criando uma dinâmica social e económica muito importante, com impacto em toda a região.)

Summary:

Mr. President reported that, along with district mayors, he visited the construction site of the new Évora Central Hospital on the 21st, at the invitation of the Alentejo Regional Health Authority (ARS Alentejo). It will serve as a reference hospital for the entire region, and a medical school is also planned. Several biotechnology and healthcare companies plan to establish a presence nearby, creating a hub for training and attracting qualified professionals and technology companies. **[74 words]**

(PT: O Sr. Presidente informou que, juntamente com autarcas do distrito, visitou, a convite da Administração Regional de Saúde do Alentejo, as obras do novo Hospital Central de Évora no dia 21. Será um hospital de referência para toda a região, estando prevista a criação de uma escola de medicina. Várias empresas de biotecnologia e de saúde pretendem instalar-se perto, criando um polo de formação e atração de profissionais qualificados e de empresas tecnológicas.)

A.2.4.2. Campo Maior 007_2024

Text to be summarized:

Assessment of the information (record 5911) from the financial services, regarding the matter in question, transcribed as follows:

“Following the documentation submitted by CEAN – Alice Nabeiro Educational Center regarding the organization of the 2024 graduating students’ trip to Paris, and after reviewing the documents provided by the entity, and given that the main activity is of an educational and social nature, I suggest a grant of €500, which I consider reasonable for the type of activity described. The proposed amount is budgeted under the Major Option of the Plan, 2 232 2011/5044 – Current Transfers to Cultural Institutions, with a total allocation of €150,000 in the 2023 Forecast Documents. For the above reasons, this concludes the information I can provide regarding the matter in question.”

The City Council unanimously deliberated to grant €500 to CEAN – Alice Nabeiro Educational Center to support the 2024 graduating students’ trip. **[145 words]**

(PT: Apreciação da informação (registo 5911) dos serviços financeiros, referente ao assunto em epígrafe, que a seguir se transcreve:

“Na sequência da documentação apresentada pelo CEAN – Centro Educativo Alice Nabeiro no âmbito da realização de uma Viagem de Finalistas a Paris, e após análise dos referidos documentos da mencionada entidade e visto a atividade preponderante ser de índole educativo e social, o valor que sugiro quantifica-se em 500,00 (quinhentos euros) o qual considero razoável para o tipo de atividade referida. O valor sugerido tem cobertura orçamental através da Grande Opção do Plano, 2 232 2011/5044 – Transferências Correntes para Instituições Culturais, cuja dotação global prevista nos Documentos Previsionais para o Exercício 2023 é de 150.000,00 €. Pelo exposto e para efeitos de apreciação por parte de V. Exas., é tudo o que me cabe informar, acerca do assunto mencionado em epígrafe”.

A Câmara deliberou, por unanimidade, atribuir um apoio no valor de 500,00€ (quinhentos euros) ao CEAN – Centro Educativo Alice Nabeiro, tendo em vista ajudar a custear a viagem de finalistas 2024.)

Summary:

The City Council unanimously approved a grant of 500,00€ to CEAN – Alice Nabeiro Educational Center, for the 2024 graduating students’ trip. The grant is covered by the *Grande Opção do Plano* for cultural institutions. **[34 words]**

(PT: A Câmara deliberou, por unanimidade, a atribuição de um apoio ao CEAN – Centro Educativo Alice Nabeiro, no valor de 500,00€, para a realização da viagem de finalistas de 2024. O valor do apoio está coberto pela Grande Opção do Plano para instituições culturais.)

A.2.4.3. Covilhã 003-A_2021

Text to be summarized:

Amend item 5.2, subparagraph f – DFMA – to: “f. Repeal of the decision of 13/09/2017 and restriction of the operating hours of the establishment ‘Equilíbrio’, located in Jardim Público – Covilhã.” [29 words]

(PT: Alterar a alínea f. do ponto 5.2 – DFMA – para: “f. Revogação da deliberação de 13/09/2017 e restringir os limites do horário de funcionamento do estabelecimento “Equilíbrio”, sito no Jardim Público – Covilhã”.)

Summary:

The designation of a subparagraph in item 5.2 of the Department of Finance and Administrative Modernization (DFMA) in the minutes was amended. [22 words]

(PT: Foi alterada a designação de uma alínea do ponto 5.2. do Departamento de Finanças e Modernização Administrativa (DFMA) da ata.)

A.2.4.4. Porto 007_2022

Text to be summarized:

Porto Municipal Trust Recognition Program – recognition of two local accommodation establishments.

Councillor Sérgio Aires stated that he still considers the program lacks sufficient criteria to be accepted. He noted that as long as job stability and social responsibility are not included in the recognition process for this trust seal, he does not consider the trust to be complete.

Regarding the two local accommodations, he emphasized that even if he agreed with the seal, he does not agree that it should be applied to local accommodation establishments. He also pointed out that there is still no regulation in this area, an issue about which the Mayor had expressed concern during the election campaign. He suggested that efforts should be made to establish regulation for local accommodation in the city. He declared that he would vote against it, with a statement of vote (Annex I).

Councillor Ilda Figueiredo stated that she maintains her abstention from the previous meeting, given the difficulty of including all issues related to labor matters and social responsibility in the classification. She considered the existence of a regulation for local accommodation to be fundamental. She also noted that, regarding the previous proposal, she had positive personal experiences in distributing Christmas materials, for example.

The proposal was approved by majority, with one abstention from Councillor of the CDU and one vote against from the Councillor of the BE. [229 words]

(PT: Programa Municipal de Reconhecimento Confiança Porto – reconhecimento de dois estabelecimentos de alojamento local.

O Senhor Vereador Sérgio Aires disse que continua a considerar que faltam critérios neste programa para poder aceitá-lo. Referiu que enquanto a estabilidade laboral e a responsabilidade social não estiverem contemplados no próprio processo de reconhecimento deste selo de confiança não considera que a confiança seja total.

Em relação aos dois alojamentos locais, sublinhou que mesmo que concordasse com o selo não concorda que este seja aplicado a estabelecimentos de alojamento local.

Sublinhou que continuam sem ter um regulamento nesta área, algo sobre o qual o Senhor Presidente, durante a campanha eleitoral, manifestou preocupação. Considerou que deviam tentar concretizar a regulamentação do alojamento local na Cidade.

Declarou que votará contra com declaração de voto. (Anexo I)

A Senhora Vereadora Ilda Figueiredo disse que mantém a abstenção da reunião anterior, tendo em conta a dificuldade de incluir todo o problema das questões laborais e da responsabilidade social na classificação.

Considerou fundamental a existência de um regulamento do alojamento local.

Referiu que, em relação à proposta anterior, tem experiências pessoais positivas na distribuição do material de Natal, por exemplo.

Aprovada, por maioria, com 1 abstenção da Senhora Vereadora da CDU e com 1 voto contra do Senhor Vereador do BE.)

Summary:

The Municipal Executive approved, by majority, with one abstention and one vote against, the recognition of two local accommodation establishments under the Porto Municipal Trust Recognition Program.

Councillor Sérgio Aires argued that social responsibility criteria are lacking and that the trust seal should not cover local accommodation. Councillor Ilda Figueiredo reiterated the need for a municipal regulation for this activity. [60 words]

(PT: O Executivo Municipal aprovou, por maioria, com uma abstenção e um voto contra, o reconhecimento de dois estabelecimentos de alojamento local no âmbito do Programa Municipal de Reconhecimento “Confiança Porto”.

O Sr. Vereador Sérgio Aires defendeu que faltam critérios de responsabilidade social e que o selo de confiança não deve abranger o alojamento local. A Sr.ª Vereadora Ilda Figueiredo reiterou a necessidade de um regulamento municipal para esta atividade.)

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